

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Meta Platforms is in advanced talks to invest around \$14 billion in Scale AI and hire the startup's chief executive, Alexandr Wang, to help lead its artificial-intelligence efforts. B1**

◆ **General Motors is spending \$4 billion to produce more vehicles in the U.S., as it looks to avoid tariffs. B1**

◆ **Daimler Truck and Toyota will merge their Japanese truck units in a bid to increase efficiencies in development, procurement and production. B1**

◆ **Signs of progress in trade talks between the U.S. and China helped lift the S&P 500 by 0.5% in a session that saw the Nasdaq and Dow gain 0.6% and 0.2%, respectively. B11**

◆ **Wall Street's push to sell private-equity and private-debt funds to individual investors risks overheating financial markets and backfiring on firms launching the funds, Moody's said. B1**

◆ **Chatbots are replacing Google's traditional search, devastating traffic that publishers have relied on for years, numbers from data firm Similarweb reveal. B1**

◆ **Supermarket shelves are emptying at some stores around the country, after a cyberattack hit a major distributor to Whole Foods Market and other chains. B3**

◆ **Kering said it acquired Italy's Lenti, building on the industrial development strategy of the luxury group's eyewear business. B2**

◆ **Insurance broker Brown & Brown agreed to acquire Accession Risk Management Group in a cash-and-stock deal valued at \$9.83 billion. B3**

World-Wide

◆ **California officials asked a federal court to block National Guard members and Marines from law-enforcement activities in Los Angeles, as Trump defended his decision to send the troops to the city. A1, A4-5**

◆ **U.S. and Chinese negotiators wrapped up two days of talks with what they said was a framework to get their trade detente back on track. A1**

◆ **A federal appeals court kept Trump's far-reaching tariffs in effect for now but agreed to fast-track its consideration of the case. A2**

◆ **As markets tanked in the wake of Trump's "Liberation Day" tariffs in early April, members of Congress and their families made hundreds of stock trades. A1**

◆ **The Smithsonian is conducting a review of all of its content in its 21 museums and zoo to eliminate political influence and bias. A3**

◆ **Democratic senators looked for answers from a government statistics agency after a hiring freeze forced cutbacks in the survey that determines the U.S. inflation rate. A3**

◆ **Five Western countries imposed sanctions against two senior far-right Israeli cabinet members. A6**

◆ **Several U.S. government agencies in 2022 and 2023 tracked foreign nationals visiting tech billionaire Elon Musk's properties. A3**

◆ **The European Commission proposed banning transactions with Russia's Nord Stream gas pipelines and cutting the price cap on Russian oil as part of a round of sanctions against the Kremlin. A16**

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Ten Killed in Shooting at Austria High School



SHOCK AND MOURNING: People lighted candles in tribute in Graz, Austria, after a school shooting in the city left 10 dead. Police said the suspect, a former student at the school, killed himself after a rare school shooting to take place in Europe. **A7**

U.S. and China Agree to Get Trade Detente Back on Track

After two days of talks, negotiators say they will restore earlier framework

LONDON—U.S. and Chinese negotiators wrapped up two days of intense talks here with what they said was a frame-

By Max Colchester, Caitlin McCabe and Lingling Wei

work to get their trade detente back on track and ratchet down tensions between the two big-

gest economies. Representatives from the countries said the framework would essentially restore a pact they agreed to in Switzerland last month, a deal that saw both sides lower tariffs and was premised in part on Beijing's promise to speed critical mineral-export licenses while the negotiators kept talking. "The two largest economies in the world have reached a handshake for a framework," Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said. "We're going to start to implement that framework upon the approval of President Trump, and the

Chinese will get their President Xi's approval, and that's the process." A senior Chinese negotiator, Li Chenggang, nodded to Lutnick's remarks, saying the two sides "agreed in principle." The framework marked the latest twist in a winding trade war—one that had been ratcheting up in recent weeks following the earlier detente. A key goal for the U.S. negotiators, led by Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Lutnick, was to get China to speed up exports of rare-earth minerals and magnets containing them as their Chinese

counterparts had agreed to in Geneva last month. The Chinese team, led by Vice Premier He Lifeng, a trusted aide to leader Xi Jinping, drove a hard bargain by asking the U.S. side to loosen restrictions significantly on the sale of technology and other products to China, according to people familiar with the matter. The negotiators didn't disagree. *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Appeals court lets tariffs stand for now..... A2**
◆ **World Bank says tariffs to slow economic growth... A6**

Lawmakers' Trades Followed Tariff Shift

WASHINGTON—As markets tanked in the wake of President Trump's "Liberation Day" tariffs in early April, members of Congress and their families

By Katy Stech Ferek, Jack Gillum, James Benedict and Gunjan Banerji

made hundreds of stock trades, shining a spotlight on a controversial practice that some lawmakers have pushed to ban. From April 2, when Trump launched the sweeping tariffs,

to April 8, the day before he paused many of them, more than a dozen House lawmakers and their family members made more than 700 stock trades, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis of disclosure filings. Top stocks purchased in that period, by the number of trades listed in the disclosures, included MKS Instruments and JPMorgan Chase, while the most sold stocks included Honeywell International and Visa. Two lawmakers who have *Please turn to page A2*

A Magician's Biggest Trick: Heel to Hero

Secret-spilling performer finds fame in Brazil

By SAMANTHA PEARSON

SÃO PAULO—Val Valentino spent years enduring boos and the occasional death threat as a magician bent on exposing the secrets behind the world's most popular tricks. Today the 68-year-old from California is treated like a hero. It's not because he stopped violating the magician's code. He just moved to Brazil. Residents of the South American country live in constant fear of being taken advantage of—by corrupt politicians or scheming criminals—and don't take kindly to being tricked, by magicians or any-

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Another Ugly Breakup Hits MAGA World

Brandon Straka accuses former friend Scott Presler of gift and betrayal

By JOSHUA CHAFFIN

In happier times Brandon Straka and Scott Presler were friends. A photo of them from a 2018 Washington, D.C., movie premiere shows them wearing matching MAGA uniforms: dark suit, white shirt, red tie. "Ahhh—two years ago today I met Scott Presler for the first time and we were also kinda twinning," Straka reminisced, posting the image on social media. To which Presler replied: "I adore you, Brandon. You're a good man, a friend & I'm proud to stand with you on the battlefield." Both had risen from the margins to become charismatic MAGA celebrities with

Media Deal Machine Shifting Into Gear

By JOE FLINT

The ranks of media owners and entertainment companies are poised for their biggest makeover in a generation. Media titans like **Comcast** and **Warner Bros. Discovery** are cleaving off their cable-television channels, while television-station operators like Allen Media and **Apollo Global Management** are exploring selling dozens of stations. **Cox** and **Charter**, two of the biggest cable and broadband companies, have

agreed to merge. Warner said on Monday it will split into two publicly traded companies. One will house its flagship movie and television studios and HBO Max streaming service, while the other will consist primarily of cable channels such as CNN, TNT and Food Network. Such changes promise to remake the television firmament, creating a new media and entertainment landscape. Media and entertainment companies are trying to "get *Please turn to page A4*

salesforce

Agentforce can help millions of flyers navigate travel hiccups. Every hour.

Agentforce What AI Was Meant to Be